

Hillsborough Pediatrics Dosing Guide

(or what you need to know to correctly dose acetaminophen or ibuprofen but were afraid to ask)

What you need to know: Due to the recent recalls for both acetaminophen and ibuprofen, dosing for both of these medications has become very confusing due to changes in labeling and changes in concentrations of the medications. To make it easy for you please follow these steps

1. Always dose by the approximate weight (not age) of your child.
2. Look to see what medication you have and its concentration. (i.e. how many mg/mL)
3. Use the below tables to find the correct dose. Measure carefully with syringe or medication cup. **DO NOT USE KITCHEN SPOON OR COOKING MEASURING SPOON** as these were not made for medications.

Acetaminophen (brand name – Tylenol)

*****dose every 4-6 hrs as needed with no more than 5 doses in 24 hrs*****

Infant's concentrated drops **80 mg/0.8 mL**

Weight (lbs)	Dose (mL)	
6-11 lbs	0.4 mL	(40 mg)
12-17 lbs	0.8 mL	(80 mg)
18-23 lbs	1.2 mL	(120 mg)
24-35 lbs	1.6 mL	(160 mg)

Infant's oral suspension **160 mg/5 mL**

Weight (lbs)	Dose (mL)	
6-11 lbs	1.25 mL	(40 mg)
12-17 lbs	2.5 mL	(80 mg)
18-23 lbs	3.75 mL	(120 mg)
24-35 lbs	5 mL	(160 mg)

Acetaminophen (brand name – Tylenol)*****dose every 4-6 hrs as needed with no more than 5 doses in 24 hrs*******Children's oral suspension 160 mg/5 mL**

Note: This medication generally comes with a dosing cup, but a syringe that measures either teaspoons (tsp) or milliliters (mL) may also be used. If this is the medication that you have and you need to use it for a child <24 lbs use the table on page 1 (infant oral suspension) for dosing and use a mL syringe.

Weight (lbs)	Dose	
24-35 lbs	1 tsp or 5 ml	(160 mg)
36-47 lbs	1-1/2 tsp or 7.5 ml	(240 mg)
48-59 lbs	2 tsp or 10 ml	(320 mg)
60-71 lbs	2-1/2 tsp or 12.5 ml	(400 mg)
72-95 lbs	3 tsp or 15 ml	(480 mg)

Ibuprofen (brand name – Motrin, Advil)*****dose every 6-8 hrs as needed with no more than 4 doses in 24 hrs*******Infant's concentrated drops 50 mg/1.25 ml****Not generally recommended for under 6 months of age**

Weight (lbs)	Dose	
12-17 lbs	1.25 ml	(50 mg)
18-23 lbs	1.875 ml	(75 mg)
24-35 lbs	2.5 ml	(100 mg)

Ibuprofen (brand name – Motrin, Advil)

*****dose every 6-8 hrs as needed with no more than 4 doses in 24 hrs*****

Children's oral suspension 100 mg/5 ml

Note: This medication generally comes with a dosing cup, but a syringe that measures either teaspoons (tsp) or milliliters (mL) may also be used.

Weight (lbs)	Dose
24-35 lbs	1 tsp or 5 ml (100 mg)
36-47 lbs	1-1/2 tsp or 7.5 ml (150 mg)
48-59 lbs	2 tsp or 10 ml (200 mg)
60-71 lbs	2-1/2 tsp or 12.5 ml (250 mg)
72-95 lbs	3 tsp or 15 ml (300 mg)

For chewable, meltaways or junior tablets or caplets, refer to the mg amounts listed on the right hand side of the tables.

For patients > 95 lbs, OK to use adult recommended dosing. For acetaminophen (Tylenol) 650 mg every 4-6 hours as needed. For ibuprofen (Motrin, Advil) 400 mg every 6 hours as needed.

We hope this helps, but if any questions do not hesitate to call.

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